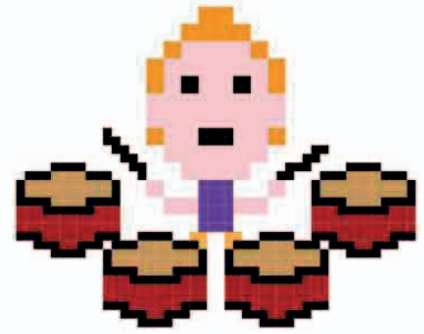


Making your own music

Scratch has blocks that can be used to invent musical sounds. You have a whole orchestra of instruments to conduct, as well as a full drum kit. The length of each note is measured in beats.



This decides how low or high the pitch of a note is

play note 60 ▼ for 0.5 beats

Big numbers make a note longer. It can also be shorter than a beat, as shown here

set instrument to 1 ▼

Click here to choose an instrument from a drop-down menu

play drum 1 ▼ for 0.25 beats

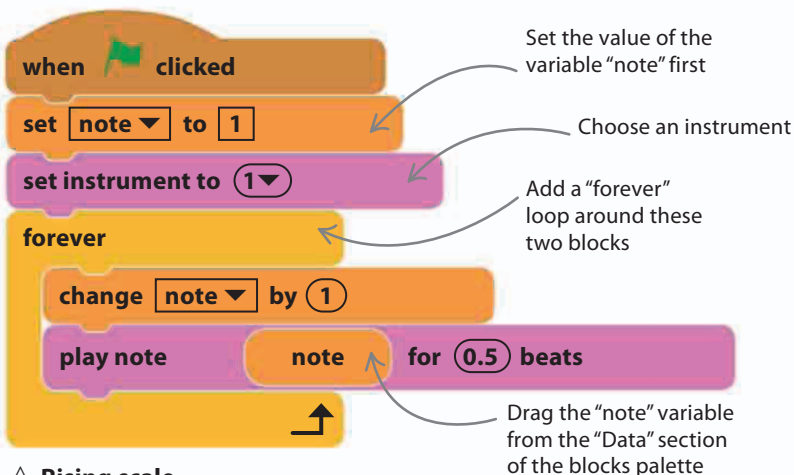
Use this menu to choose between different types of drum

rest for 0.25 beats

This block adds a silent break in the music. Higher numbers will give you a longer break

Playing music

Connecting notes together makes a tune. Create a new variable called "note" (see pages 50–51), and then add the script below to any sprite to create a piece of music.



△ Rising scale

This script makes a series of notes that play when the green flag is clicked. The pitch of each note gets higher one step at a time, and each note plays for half a beat.



EXPERT TIPS

Tempo

The speed of music is called its tempo. The tempo decides how long a beat is within a piece of music. There are three blocks for managing the tempo.

set tempo to 60 bpm

The tempo is measured in beats per minute, or "bpm."

change tempo by 60

Increase the tempo to make your music faster, or use a negative number to make it slower.

☐ tempo

Checking this box makes the sprite's tempo show on the stage.